

A city of commerce in the shape of a butterfly

Apart from its 6,800 showrooms, PIMM offers a wide variety of facilities designed to make life easy for the people working, visiting, and doing business at the wholesale centre. As a consequence, there are several ways of joining PIMM, by buying or leasing apartments, offices, or showrooms.

"PIMM will have restaurants, hotels, office parks, a banking section, and condominiums, organised as a modern city of commerce with its own infrastructure. We have a fire station, a hospital, we have 64 buildings. Everything has been organised carefully from the beginning. We have thought of everything for the comfort of sellers, buyers, and the people who live at PIMM," explains Katz.

The entire structure of PIMM is shaped like a gigantic butterfly – inspired by the meaning of "Panama" in the country's original Indian language. To facilitate access to the showrooms with equal opportunity for all operators, they will all be placed on the ground floor only. Due to this design, and the fact that PIMM is located on a piece of land which is already plane, the entire construction can be completed in only two years, allowing PIMM to open by the end of 2009 or beginning of 2010. Comments Katz, "Each showroom building spans 25,000 square metres with inside showrooms that are adjustable, modulable, in different sizes to meet the requirements of individual buyers. Both small and big companies can operate at PIMM. Everyone is accepted, and everybody is welcome."

Given its physical and financial dimensions, PIMM is expected to have a profound impact on the Panamanian economy. "PIMM is going to generate \$550m of indirect revenue to the country, we will have 30,000 employees. PIMM will also be the largest tax payer in the country, because we must pay taxes on our profit. We have calculated that PIMM will generate \$1bn profit over the next ten years and pay \$33m in taxes every year – but only PIMM, not the tenants. These have no taxes on profits, nothing to pay," explains Katz.

The entire structure of PIMM is shaped like a gigantic butterfly – inspired by the meaning of "Panama" in the country's original Indian language. To facilitate access to the showrooms with equal opportunity for all operators, they will all be placed on the ground floor only.

PIMM's physical structure forms a gigantic butterfly. ▼

